

UPSC Civil Services (Main) Simulation GS-II

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 250

Q1. Compare and contrast the British and Indian approaches to Parliamentary sovereignty.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (130 words; practice model, not official): Britain and India share responsible cabinet government, but not the same source of legal supremacy. Under orthodox British doctrine, Parliament may enact or repeal any law; courts cannot invalidate an Act merely for inconsistency with a superior codified Constitution. Conventions regulate much executive practice. India adopts constitutional supremacy. Parliament's competence is limited by the Seventh Schedule, Fundamental Rights and other constitutional provisions, and laws face judicial review. Even Article 368 power is limited by the basic-structure doctrine; federalism and bicameralism further distribute authority. The similarity is political: in both systems the cabinet survives through lower-House confidence and normally leads the legislative agenda. India therefore borrowed Westminster responsibility but constitutionalised and limited Parliament. British sovereignty concerns legal competence; Indian parliamentary supremacy means political control over the executive within a supreme Constitution.

Q2. Explain the three components of the Sevottam model and their interdependence.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (107 words; practice model, not official): The three pillars fail whenever they move apart, because a promise without capability is a paper standard, capability without a grievance route is unaccountable competence and grievance machinery without capability merely records failure, so interdependence rather than enumeration is what the question is testing. Citizen-centric administration is an institutional architecture rather than a single document, combining a service-standard promise, a working grievance route, statutory service guarantees where they exist, the organisational capacity to deliver and an integrated access point, so a charter by itself is necessary and far from sufficient and an answer that treats the charter as the whole subject has already narrowed its own scope.

Q3. Examine the recognition and anti-discrimination provisions of the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019, and assess how far they convert recognition into access.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (129 words; practice model, not official): 1. The Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019, with Rules notified in 2020, defines a transgender person as a person whose gender does not match the gender assigned at birth, and available evidence indicates that the definition expressly includes trans-men, trans-women, persons with intersex variations, genderqueer persons and persons with socio-cultural identities such as kinnar, hijra, aravani and jogta; the examinable point is that the statute uses an inclusive enumeration rather than a single medicalised test, so an answer that reduces the category to one community or to a surgical status has narrowed the definition Parliament actually enacted. 2. The owners keep two certification routes apart. A District Magistrate issues the basic certificate recognising a person's self-perceived transgender identity, and no medical or surgical requirement applies to it.

Q4. How do Articles 1 and 3 combine national unity with territorial adaptability?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (145 words; practice model, not official): Article 1 establishes India as a Union of States: the constitutional order is not a treaty among sovereign units and contains no unilateral right of secession. Article 3 gives Parliament power to form new States and alter areas, boundaries or names. The process nevertheless contains consultation. A Bill requires the President's recommendation, and the President refers it to the affected State legislature for views within the specified period. Those views are not binding. Article 4 permits supplemental changes and excludes such a law from Article 368 merely because schedules and representation are adjusted. This flexibility enabled linguistic and later territorial reorganisation without repeatedly re-founding the Union. Its democratic weakness is that an affected State lacks consent power. Parliament should therefore use prior consultation, reasoned criteria and transition safeguards. Articles 1 and 3 make the Union indestructible but its internal map adaptable. Answer-prose count: 141 words.

Q5. Discuss why recent amendments affecting the transparency regime raise a question about the autonomy of the Information Commission.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (114 words; practice model, not official): Autonomy and scope are two separate live questions: a body whose tenure and service conditions are fixed by the executive it adjudicates against faces a structural independence problem irrespective of the

holder's integrity, while a substituted exemption changes the breadth of the right the same body enforces. Accountability is not transparency plus good intentions but a three-part chain - transparency, meaning visibility of records, spending and decisions; answerability, meaning an identifiable authority obliged to explain; and enforceability, meaning correction, remedy or consequence - and India has built the first extensively, the second unevenly and the third rarely, which is why an answer that opens by separating the three immediately outperforms one that treats them as synonyms.

Q6. Distinguish manual scavenging from hazardous cleaning under the Prohibition of Employment as Manual Scavengers and their Rehabilitation Act, 2013, and examine the challenges in enforcing both prohibitions.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (150 words; practice model, not official): 1. available evidence indicates that manual scavenging under the Prohibition of Employment as Manual Scavengers and their Rehabilitation Act, 2013 as employment or engagement to manually clean, carry, dispose of or otherwise handle human excreta from the statutory insanitary-latrines, open-drains, pits or railway-track settings before it fully decomposes, and they attach the decisive qualification that protective equipment does not turn manual scavenging into a lawful practice. The definition is therefore about the act and its setting rather than about the gear worn while performing it, which is why a mechanisation answer that offers only protective equipment does not answer the prohibition. 2. available evidence indicates that hazardous cleaning under the same Act as the manual cleaning of a sewer, a septic tank or a specified space without the prescribed protective gear, cleaning devices and safety precautions, and they record it as distinct from manual scavenging even though both are prohibited.

Q7. Explain the constitutional relationship between Articles 256, 257, 365 and 356. Why is non-compliance with Union directions not equivalent to automatic President's Rule?

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (147 words; practice model, not official): Article 256 requires States to ensure compliance with parliamentary and applicable laws and permits Union directions for that purpose. Article 257 requires State executive power not to impede Union executive power and permits specified directions concerning national/military communications and railway protection. Article 365 provides that failure to comply with Union directions may permit the President to hold that State government cannot be carried on according to the Constitution. It therefore supplies a relevant constitutional inference. It does not automatically impose President's Rule. Article 356 still requires presidential satisfaction based on relevant material, parliamentary approval and temporal limits. S.R. Bommai makes the proclamation reviewable and ordinarily protects floor determination of political majority. Thus, Articles 256-257 enable coordination, Article 365 marks serious non-compliance, and Article 356 supplies the exceptional remedy. Treating the sequence as automatic would convert federal directions into unrestricted Union control. Answer-prose count: 143 words.

Q8. Discuss why capacity building alone cannot resolve the politicisation of the Indian civil service.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (109 words; practice model, not official): Capacity reform improves the officer while politicisation operates on the institution through posting and transfer discretion, so a competency programme that leaves the incentive structure untouched raises capability without changing the behaviour that the incentive structure rewards, and the defensible position pairs capacity investment with transfer transparency, minimum-tenure norms and appraisal consequence. The protections against that chain are a transparent transfer and posting process, minimum-tenure norms, written reasons for any deviation, recorded advice, a functioning appraisal with meaningful differentiation and institutional rather than personal accountability for outcomes, and stating them as a connected set is what converts a description of politicisation into a reform answer that answers the directive.

Q9. Distinguish statutory recognition of a platform worker from operational social-security coverage, and explain what evidence would show the difference.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (137 words; practice model, not official): 1. available evidence indicates that the Code's statutory definition of a gig worker as a person who performs work or participates in a work arrangement and earns from activities outside the traditional employer-employee relationship, and they attach the decisive qualification that the definition gives statutory recognition within the Code and does not by itself guarantee a benefit. The examinable move is to treat the definition as the entry condition for a social-security architecture rather than as the architecture itself, because recognition tells you who may be covered while a notified scheme tells you what they receive. 2. available evidence indicates that the Code's statutory definition of a platform worker as a person engaged in platform work outside a traditional employer-employee relationship, using an online platform to access organisations or individuals for specific services in exchange for payment.

Q10. Differentiate Articles 358 and 359 after the 44th Amendment.

[10 marks | 150 words]

Model answer (140 words; practice model, not official): Claim: Articles 358 and 359 create different, bounded rights consequences rather than a blanket suspension of Part III. Named evidence: Article 358 operates automatically, concerns Article 19 alone and applies only during war or external-aggression Emergency. Its shield requires an emergency-related recital and covers executive action under such a law. Article 359 needs a presidential order and suspends the right to move courts for enforcement of specified Part III rights and relevant pending proceedings. Analysis: Article 358 changes Article 19's constraint for a narrow trigger; Article 359 restricts the enforcement route named in the order. Article 359(1A)-(1B) also uses recital and nexus controls. Qualification: Articles 20 and 21 can never be included after the 44th Amendment. On cessation, protected laws lose prospective immunity to the extent of ordinary incompetency, while past acts remain governed by the saving clauses.

Q11. Explain how committee government strengthened the deliberative process of the Constituent Assembly.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (197 words; practice model, not official): Committee government converted a vast and conflict-ridden constitutional agenda into specialised, negotiable and draftable units. Nehru's Union Powers and Union Constitution Committees framed central architecture; Patel's Provincial Constitution and Advisory Committees linked federal design with rights, minority and tribal safeguards. The Kripalani, H.C. Mookherjee, Gopinath Bardoloi and A.V. Thakkar subcommittees deepened issue-specific scrutiny. This architecture separated four functions. First, subject committees gathered evidence and narrowed choices. Second, B.N. Rau supplied comparative advice and an initial draft. Third, Ambedkar's Drafting Committee reconciled reports into coherent legal text. Fourth, the plenary Assembly publicly debated, amended and authorised that text. The movement between smaller committees, party forums, informal negotiation and plenary sessions reduced deadlock without eliminating dissent. The mechanism strengthened deliberation in three ways: expertise improved precision; smaller forums made bargaining manageable; and plenary readings preserved public reasons and final authority. The cost was possible technocratic insulation and opacity in pre-plenary settlements, intensified by Congress dominance and unequal representation. Committee work was legitimate because it remained subordinate to the Assembly. Thus, specialisation did not replace deliberation; it organised it. The durability of the final settlement arose from expert preparation joined to political negotiation and public constitutional authorisation.

Q12. Examine whether increasing dependence on donor agencies reduces the importance of community participation in development.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (170 words; practice model, not official): Dependence is a design property rather than an inherent property of external finance, because the same rupee strengthens or displaces participation depending on who sets the agenda, who defines the metric and who receives the report. Donor funding weakens community participation through four named channels - the agenda channel where donor priorities set the problem before local need is assessed, the metric channel where reporting rewards countable outputs so slow participatory processes are cut first, the cycle channel where project-based time-bound grants mismatch the multi-year horizon community institutions need, and the accountability-substitution channel where upward donor reporting replaces downward answerability - so dependence is a design property rather than an inherent property of external finance. Donor-driven development is designed around the funder's theory of change and reporting metrics while demand-driven development is designed around locally articulated priority, and the two can converge but frequently diverge, especially where project-based time-bound funding cycles mismatch a long-term local need, so the tension is the standard evaluative counterpoint to any claim that external finance improves inclusion.

Q13. Examine the claim that a focus on food availability rather than on human-development policy is the principal cause of hunger in India.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (193 words; practice model, not official): Availability is only the first of four stages, so the examination must test the claim against access, absorption and utilisation, concede what the availability argument does explain, and end by naming the conversion failures that grain allocation cannot reach. Food security is reliable access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food to meet dietary needs and is addressed in India primarily through the statutory foodgrain entitlement, which is a calorie and grain-access instrument, whereas nutrition security goes beyond calorie access to include dietary diversity, micronutrients, care practices and the health and sanitation environment and is therefore multi-sectoral; the examinable consequence is that the public distribution system can be working exactly as designed while nutrition outcomes stagnate, so the two must never be argued as one. Nutrition-specific interventions directly target nutritional outcomes through supplementary feeding, micronutrient supplementation, growth monitoring and breastfeeding promotion, whereas nutrition-sensitive interventions address the underlying determinants through other sectors, including water, sanitation and hygiene, agricultural diversification, social protection and women's education, and act on nutrition indirectly; the convergence argument in a Mains answer rests entirely on this distinction, because it explains why stunting reduction cannot be procured from the food ministry alone.

Q14. Examine the concrete instruments through which the West's supply-chain diversification interest in India has been expressed, and state what they do not establish.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (238 words; practice model, not official): The instruments are real, dated and cumulative but each stops at a specific evidentiary level, so the examination must run from the initiative of May 2022 through the review of 17 June 2024, the clean-energy commitments of 21 September 2024 and the branding of 13 February 2025, and close by refusing the replacement narrative in favour of diversification of dependence. Friend-shoring means relocating or diversifying critical supply chains toward geopolitically aligned or trusted partners, which is distinct from simple offshoring based on cost alone, and it is the policy logic behind India-United States and India-European Union technology cooperation, with critical minerals such as rare earths, lithium and cobalt and semiconductor fabrication and packaging capacity treated as strategic-supply-chain priorities; the correction available evidence indicates that upon is that Western diversification interest makes India an alternative production and technology-cooperation base rather than a replacement for China, and treating it as replacement is analytically and empirically incorrect at current scale. The initiative on Critical and Emerging Technology, abbreviated iCET, was announced in May 2022, held its inaugural National Security Adviser-level meeting on 31 January 2023 and a second National Security Adviser-level review on 17 June 2024, covering semiconductors, artificial intelligence, space and defence-industrial cooperation; available evidence indicates that its evidentiary level precisely as a cooperation initiative and not a treaty or framework agreement, and they warn that treating it as a defence-alliance treaty misstates both its legal character and India's obligations.

Q15. Examine the relationship among Fundamental Rights, Directive Principles and Fundamental Duties as a salient feature of the Constitution.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (182 words; practice model, not official): Parts III, IV and IV-A express three dimensions of constitutional citizenship. Fundamental Rights are justiciable guarantees that protect liberty, equality, dignity and political democracy. Article 32 provides a constitutional remedy, although rights remain subject to constitutionally valid restrictions. Directive Principles are non-justiciable under Article 37 but fundamental in governance. They orient legislation and administration towards social and economic democracy and the welfare state. Fundamental Duties under Article 51A are non-justiciable civic obligations; ten were added by the 42nd Amendment and an eleventh by the 86th Amendment. Their relationship is complementary rather than hierarchical. Rights prevent social transformation from becoming arbitrary; DPSP prevent liberty from being reduced to formal non-interference; Duties emphasise responsible citizenship and may guide interpretation or legislation. Minerva Mills (1980) treated harmony between Parts III and IV as central to the constitutional balance. Limits remain essential. DPSP do not become directly enforceable merely because they are fundamental in governance, and Duties do not automatically create penal offences. Nor may welfare claims erase basic rights. The salient feature is therefore a differentiated but integrated architecture of freedom, welfare and civic responsibility.

Q16. Examine the challenges of treating civil society and non-governmental organisations as an alternative model of public service delivery.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (217 words; practice model, not official): Civil society should be commissioned for innovation, facilitation and monitoring and never made the duty-holder for an entitlement, because scale, sustainability, accountability direction, capacity variation, substitution risk and regulatory dependence all bear on the same structural point that the state cannot contract out an addressee. Civil society is a superior innovator, facilitator and monitor and an inferior duty-holder, because a right needs an addressee who can be compelled and no non-governmental organisation can be compelled in that way, and the six named challenges of the alternative delivery model are partial geographic scale, project-cycle sustainability against a permanent entitlement, upward rather than downward accountability with no electoral sanction, variation in capacity and standards between organisations, substitution risk that relieves political pressure to fix public delivery, and regulatory dependence that makes scale legally contingent. NGO Darpan is a NITI Aayog identification and database portal that assigns a unique identification number required for Union-government grants and used in linked compliance interfaces, it is largely self-reported and light-touch, and it is not incorporation, not foreign-funding permission and not tax exemption. The most excluded households are frequently not members of any self-help group, which is the sharpest limitation on every self-help-group-based inclusion claim, and stating it converts a celebratory answer about mobilisation into an evaluative one about who the mobilisation actually reaches.

Q17. Examine the claim that insurance-led financing alone can deliver financial protection in health.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (200 words; practice model, not official): Insurance covers the catastrophic tail while most household spending is recurring and outpatient, so the examination must run the financing chain, use the dated expenditure sequence and end with a conditional rather than a categorical verdict. The financing chain runs from revenue collection through risk pooling and strategic purchasing to service provision, and available evidence indicates that the decisive consequence that insurance without public primary care leaves prevention, medicines and outpatient out-of-pocket expenditure unresolved; this is the analytical core of any question about financial protection, because hospitalisation cover addresses the catastrophic tail while the recurring outpatient and medicine burden, which is where most household health spending actually occurs, is addressed only by funded primary provision. Catastrophic health expenditure is health spending that exceeds a threshold share of household income or consumption, commonly stated in the range of ten to twenty-five per cent, and it pushes households into poverty or debt, with high out-of-pocket expenditure as its primary driver; this is the mechanism that makes health a social-justice question rather than only a service-delivery question, because a single hospitalisation can undo years of asset accumulation, and it is the bridge that connects this topic to the related

poverty and nutrition analysis.

Q18. Examine the connectivity architecture India has built around the Pakistan transit constraint and assess how far third-party measures condition it.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (148 words; practice model, not official): The architecture is real and dated but conditioned by another state's domestic law, so the examination must set the contract of 13 May 2024 and the Ashgabat framework against the waiver revocation effective 29 September 2025 and the assurance limit of 26 April 2026, and must distinguish exposure from obligation throughout. India Ports Global Limited and Iran's Ports and Maritime Organisation signed a ten-year long-term contract for Chabahar port on 13 May 2024, with India announcing roughly one hundred and twenty million United States dollars in equipment investment and a two hundred and fifty million United States dollar credit window for mutually identified infrastructure; available evidence indicates that these to be cited as announced investment and an announced credit window rather than as delivered equipment or disbursed finance, because an announcement and a delivery are different evidentiary levels and the difference is exactly what a critical demand tests.

Q19. The word Socialist in the Preamble fixes ends, not means. Examine in the light of India's constitutional and economic experience.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (188 words; practice model, not official): Indian socialism is democratic rather than statist. Its ends were already implicit before 1976 in Directive Principles such as Articles 38 and 39: a welfare-oriented social order, reduced inequality and prevention of excessive concentration of resources. The 42nd Amendment made the commitment express. The means were never constitutionally frozen. India's mixed economy combined public action with private property and enterprise. D.S. Nakara (1982) described Indian socialism through a Gandhian-Marxian blend, while G.B. Pant University (2000) linked it to ending poverty, ignorance, disease and inequality of opportunity. Liberalisation in 1991 changed policy instruments and reduced the dominance of State ownership, but did not erase constitutional welfare goals. The present position is clearest in Dr Balram Singh (2024): neither the Constitution nor the Preamble mandates one economic model, and Socialist does not prohibit private entrepreneurship. Property Owners Association (2024) similarly recognised democratic choice in economic governance. The proposition, however, is not a licence for welfare abandonment. Policy freedom remains bounded by equality, dignity and the Directive Principles. Socialist therefore fixes a constitutional floor of welfare and opportunity while leaving nationalisation, regulation, markets and public provision to democratic choice.

Q20. Examine the continuing relevance of the Second Administrative Reforms Commission for current Indian governance reform.

[15 marks | 250 words]

Model answer (167 words; practice model, not official): The reports remain indispensable as a diagnostic map and unsafe as a statement of current practice, because their analytical categories have aged far better than their specific prescriptions, so the honest use cites the report for the problem and the current instrument for the answer while conceding what has changed since 2009. The datedness objection is that a diagnosis produced between 2006 and 2009 predates population-scale digital public infrastructure, the current data-protection framework, statutory service guarantees at scale and post-goods-and-services-tax fiscal federalism, and the correct reply is that the commission's analytical categories of capacity, accountability, citizen-centricity and decentralisation have aged far better than its specific prescriptions, so analysis should say which of the two it is using. Report eleven, Promoting e-Governance and titled The Smart Way Forward, and report twelve, Citizen-Centric Administration and titled The Heart of Governance, ground the e-governance and citizen-centric service-delivery routes, where process re-engineering before digitisation and the service-standard, grievance and capability architecture are developed in their own owners rather than restated here.

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS